

Skills Summary

Making Ten

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Find the Missing Partner to Ten

Rule: Every number to 9 has a **partner** that fills it up to ten. Partner pairs: 1 and 9, 2 and 8, 3 and 7, 4 and 6, 5 and 5.

Example: $3 + ? = 10$

Step 1. We know one partner and want the other, so we count up from 3 to 10.

Step 2. 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 — that is 7 counts, and $3 + 7 = 10$. ✓

⇒ the missing partner is **7**

Try it: $8 + ? = 10$

check: 2

Skill 2 — Decompose Ten

Rule: Taking a number out of ten leaves its partner:
if $\text{part} + \text{part} = 10$, then $10 - \text{part} = \text{other part}$.

Example: $10 - 4$

Step 1. Ten breaks into partner pairs, so instead of counting back we ask which partner goes with 4.

Step 2. $4 + 6 = 10$, so taking 4 away leaves 6. ✓

⇒ $10 - 4 = 6$

Try it: $10 - 9$

check: 1

Skill 3 — Make Ten to Add

Rule: To add two numbers, fill the bigger one up to ten first: move just enough from the smaller number, then add what is left onto 10.

Example: $8 + 5$

Step 1. Adding onto 10 is easy, so we fill 8 up to ten using part of the 5.

Step 2. 8 needs 2: split 5 into $2 + 3$. Then $8 + 2 = 10$ and $10 + 3 = 13$. ✓

⇒ $8 + 5 = 13$

Try it: $9 + 6$ (fill 9 up to ten first)

check: 15

(!) Watch out: When you move dots to make ten, do not forget the leftovers! In $9 + 4$, moving 1 to make ten leaves 3 more to add — the answer is 13, not 10.